MENTORING

Welcome and Congratulations
Congratulations on your appointment as Lodge Mentor. An important and rewarding role within Hertfordshire Freemasonry.

Your purpose is to ensure that every Brother, from a new candidate to a long-standing member, feels prepared, supported, guided and enlightened in their Masonic journey. Mentoring helps each member find their place in the Lodge, understand Freemasonry more deeply, and enjoy everything the Craft offers.

Your Core Responsibilities
As Lodge Mentor, you will:

- Coordinate and oversee all mentoring within your Lodge.
- Ensure a Personal Mentor is appointed for every candidate, and where possible, for joining or returning members.
- Support Personal Mentors with clear guidance and regular communication.
- Act as the link between your Lodge and the Provincial Mentoring Team.
- Promote mentoring as part of the Lodge culture, something every Brother benefits from.
- You don't need to act as a Personal Mentor yourself unless appropriate, but you ensure the mentoring system works smoothly and effectively.

The Four Principles of Mentoring

Prepare
Set every new member up for success:

- Explain expectations, time commitment, and Lodge culture.
- Share insights on etiquette, dress code, and punctuality.
- Outline meeting structure and key roles.
- Introduce the wearing and meaning of regalia.
- Provide a warm, informed welcome — ensuring there are no surprises.

Guide
Help each member find their direction:

- Signpost to the Provincial website and learning resources.
- Assist with learning techniques and personal development.
- Encourage visiting other Lodges and expanding connections.
- Introduce members to the Freemasons Hall Learning & Business Centre (FHLBC).
- Promote lifelong learning and active engagement within the Province.

Support
Be the steady presence behind every Brother's progress:

- Maintain regular contact and build genuine rapport.
- Offer reassurance — mistakes are part of learning.
- Encourage a healthy work/life/Masonic balance.
- Check in regularly, listen actively, and celebrate progress.
- Foster confidence, wellbeing, and belonging within the Lodge.

Enlighten
Inspire curiosity, confidence, and pride in Freemasonry:

- Encourage participation in ceremonies, such as delivering a Charge.
- Share insights into the history, symbolism, and values of the Craft.
- Explore members' aspirations and progression opportunities.
- Promote attendance at Provincial meetings and charitable initiatives.
- Reinforce the importance of community, personal growth, and living Masonic values every day.

HERTFORDSHIRE FREEMASONS

MENTORING

Making Mentoring Work in Your Lodge
Mentoring is most effective when it's seen as a shared responsibility, one that strengthens the whole Lodge and fosters lasting connections between Brethren. Involve Proposers and Seconders early in a candidate's journey, ensuring they play an active part in the mentoring process.

Match Personal Mentors thoughtfully to members, considering personality and experience, and encourage attendance at Provincial mentoring workshops to build skills and share ideas. Regularly review progress and share updates at Lodge or committee meetings, while also re-engaging Past Masters and experienced Brethren — their wisdom and insight are invaluable in guiding the next generation.

Support for You as a Mentor
The Provincial Mentoring Team is here to help.

Join the monthly Microsoft Teams drop-in on the first Tuesday of every month at 7.00pm to share ideas and ask questions.

For one-to-one support, email asstmentor@hertfordshirefreemasons.org.uk or mentor@hertfordshirefreemasons.org.uk.

We're also arranging informal meet-ups and informative events across the Province, please keep an eye on your inbox for dates and details.

In Closing
Mentoring should always be positive, inclusive, and enjoyable, a partnership built on friendship, respect, and trust.

Our driving force should be to make sure that Freemasonry is fun and everyone enjoys their time. Through the four pillars of Preparation, Support, Guidance, and Enlightenment, every Mason in Hertfordshire can grow in confidence, understanding, and pride in the Craft, ensuring Freemasonry continues to flourish for generations to come.